

**AN OFFICIAL REPORT OF THE CAPACITY BUILDING WORKSHOP ON  
“EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION STRATEGY FOR STAKEHOLDERS TO  
IMPROVE ADMINISTRATION OF CRIMINAL JUSTICE DELIVERY IN  
ANAMBRA STATE” HELD ON DAY 2 (16<sup>TH</sup> OCTOBER, 2024) AT HILTON  
LEISURE RESORT HOTEL, AWKA, ANAMBRA STATE.**

The session began by 9:36AM with the facilitator, Mr. Murkthar Suleiman (the Head of Communications for International IDEA, Nigeria), welcoming the participants.

Without further ado, Mr. Suleiman delved into the subject matter of the training – which was on content creation and messaging. He explored the concept of content creation and elaborated on what it means to create engaging content for social media platforms. He highlighted key requirements to consider when creating contents for social media.

Some of the requirements include:

1. **Know your audience:** Content creators are to understand their audience, and are to tailor the content to the needs and desires of their audience. For instance, the content that one could create in an awareness post for PWD's will be significantly different from an awareness post that is targeted at Law Enforcement Agencies.
2. **Storytelling:** A content creator must weave a compelling story that stirs emotions and resonates deeply with the audience. Stories naturally make your contents memorable.
3. **Visual Appeal:** Mr. Suleiman advised that capturing and retaining the attention of your audience on social media with your contents often demands eye catching graphics, and high quality pictures and videos. He also encouraged viscosity of words as well. He referenced Chimamanda Adichie's Purple Hibiscus, and Camara Laye's African Child, as great examples of viscosity of words.
4. **Conciseness:** While viscosity of words and creativity is highly encouraged, verbosity is to be avoided. He noted that messages should be delivered succinctly in order to catch and retain the very short attention span of social media users.
5. **Encourage User Generated Content:** Users should be encouraged to share content related to your brand. Polls and feedback mechanisms may be used to provide user generated content.

6. **Call to Action:** A clear and compelling call to action to direct your audience to take the desired action should be included in the message.
7. **Analysis and Adaptation:** He encouraged content creators to monitor and analyze how their contents were being engaged with, and to use the data to strategize or re-strategise continuously.

From Content Creation, the facilitator moved on to Messaging.

He explained that messaging is the process of crafting and developing clear, consistent and compelling statements that communicate key ideas and values of an organization, individual or campaign to a target audience.

He further explained that messaging is important for clarity and consistency; builds brand identity, and can be a tool of persuasion and influence.

The BERIC model, a personal model he developed with his team was shared with the participants. The BERIC model of messaging as he named it, allows communication experts to pass effective messaging especially when the message is sensitive or aggressive.

BERIC is an acronym for:

B = Brand (The message should focus on one thing, rather than multiple layers)

E = Entry (The core of the message should be the entry. This determines engagement of audience)

R = Repercussion (Consequences for failing to adhere to the message)

I = Instruction (A call to action which triggers or inspires the target audience)

C = Credibility (Source)

Mr. Suleiman explained that a simple message can reflect all of the above (in no particular order).

At the end of this session, the participants were broken into groups and asked to craft messages which could become content for social media.

The messages were collated and analyzed and he promised to send a feedback on the messages that would be selected and featured as designs. He equally promised to send certificates of training.

The vote of thanks was given by Mr. Alfred Ajayi, a Media Partner with RoLAC, and the session ended at 1:42PM.

**EZEKWE OLIVIA UZOMA (Esq).**

**(For the Chairman, ANSDRC)**